Jake Walder

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Senior Game Designer with a decade in games and **15+ titles** across mobile, PC and console, played by **over 170 million players**. Experience ranges from leading design and production to developing, scoring and shipping independent titles in Unity. A positive, dedicated problem-solver with a player-first mindset, focused on making every game great to play.

Showreel & Projects: Showreel · Penguin Slide · Woodoku · Meathook · The Adventure Pals

INDEPENDENT & FREELANCE WORK

Walder Games — *Independent Game Developer* Feb 2026 - Present

- Designed, developed and released *Penguin Slide* on Itch.io independently, from first prototype to launch, creating all code, art, music, SFX and levels in Unity and using AI to accelerate development.
- Developing a vertical slice of puzzle-adventure *Godmother* in Unity, designing gameplay, writing narrative and creating art, music and SFX.

Design Consultant & Composer — *MEATHOOK, Indie Title* Feb 2025 - July 2026

- Ran a full game audit and design consultation, improving core mechanics and systems, tutorial and progression flow, level design and UI/UX design.
- Co-wrote, produced, mixed and mastered the soundtrack for *Meathook* under the alias HYPNO.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Game Designer — *Tripledot Studios, London* Sept 2022 - Feb 2026

Design lead for Woodoku (150M+ downloads) and Woodoku Blast (20M+), owning the full player experience from core gameplay to live content, as part of the product team reporting to the CPO and Level Design Director.

- Raised *Woodoku* engagement by 20% and ARPDAU by 15% by redesigning the steep difficulty curve with a gentler ramp and small challenge spikes, keeping players challenged without frustrating them into churning.
- Increased *Woodoku Blast* ARPDAU by over 10% by designing and producing new features, mechanics and LiveOps events, also raising D30 retention by 5% through A/B-tested level iterations.
- Increased *Woodoku* D30 retention by 5% by engineering new shape-generation algorithms, while creating and optimising 152 levels a week for LiveOps.
- Cut level production time by 50% by designing a visual level editor to replace hand-edited JSON files: a paintbrush-and-palette workflow with instant in-editor playtesting, which also improved level quality, variety and team morale.
- Owned design across gameplay, systems, UX, haptics and audio for *Woodoku* and *Woodoku Blast*.
- Directed production of all owned features as the de facto product manager, from pre-production to post-release, with Analytics, Engineering, Art and QA, using A/B tests and player data to shape the roadmap.
- Led a 3-person design team, mentoring two designers through promotions (Junior → Senior, Junior → Mid), and completed an 8-module management programme.
- Organised and ran playtests and brainstorms, and consulted on new game projects across the studio.

Game Designer — *Playtika, London* June 2020 - June 2022

- Sole game designer, reporting to the Product Lead and owning design documentation and the design and player perspective for *BRIX Blast Friends* and *BRIX Blast Rivals*.
- Designed and curated dozens of features, managing their development from the initial idea to final implementation by writing detailed specifications and overseeing the work of the developers and artists.
- Solely responsible for level design on both titles, using player data to iterate on levels and improve retention, engagement and monetisation.

QA Lead & Level Designer — *Massive Monster, Southampton* Oct 2015 - Aug 2016

> ***'Your dedication, attitude and all round personality have made you a joy to work with.' – Jay Armstrong, Co-Founder***

- Designed and curated over 50% of the levels and designed various mechanics for *The Adventure Pals*, designed the hardest levels for *Never Give Up*, and curated and edited a large set of externally designed levels.
- Responsible for all QA and level curation for both titles, ensuring polished levels and reliable game stability.

QA Tester (Part-Time) — *Excalibur Publishing, Banbury* Oct 2015 - Aug 2016

- Responsible for QA of over 10 Steam titles, including *Jalopy* and *Shoppe Keep*, which required a strong grasp of gameplay mechanics to effectively identify, analyse and document bugs.

MUSIC

HYPNO — Electronic Music Duo June 2020 - Present

- Co-wrote, produced and mixed 3 singles released across all major music platforms and aired on BBC Introducing; created custom single artwork using Photoshop.

EDUCATION

Bournemouth University — *BSc Games Programming (2:1)* Sept 2016 - June 2019

- Completed a research dissertation involving a reaction-time-based mobile game in Unity (75%) and developed core skills through the following modules: Gameplay, Physics, UI, Core Loops and AI.

Peter Symonds College — *Maths, Physics & Computing A-Levels* Sept 2013 - June 2015

SKILLS

- **Gameplay Design**, **Level Design**, **Systems Design**, UI/UX, LiveOps, Balancing & Economy, **Wireframing**, QA Systems.
- **Unity**, **Photoshop**, Looker, Figma, Miro, VSCode, **Aseprite**, **Excel/Sheets**, GitHub, JIRA, Confluence, **Claude**, Blender.
- Experienced with **C#**, **C++** and **SQL** and utilising **AI tools** to accelerate development and create rapid **prototypes**.

INTERESTS

- **Music:** Guitarist, self-taught music producer currently writing and producing 2 albums. Previously recorded with a Grammy-winning producer, aired by BBC Introducing and performed at a music festival.
- **Travelling:** Recently took an intentional career break to travel all over Southeast Asia for 6 months.
- **Games:** Constantly playing and staying up to date with the console, PC and mobile markets.
- **Hardware & Audio:** Utilise self-taught electronics knowledge to modify guitars and create guitar pedals.